



Activity 1

Classify the following into perishable and non-perishable food items.

Salt, Sugar, Apple, Corn, Orange, Wheat, Pulses, Tomato, Papaya, Rice, Cucumber.

1 Causes

Once the food items are harvested they begin to decompose. Food can be spoiled by factors like air and oxygen, moisture, enzymes, microorganisms, light and temperature.

Air and Oxygen: When oxygen reacts with food contents, it produces changes in the colour and flavour of the food.

Moisture: Moisture keeps the food fresh. When the moisture is gone vegetables and fruits shrink. Due to evaporation, moisture loss occurs in foods like meat, fish and cheese.



Enzymes: Enzymes break down the larger molecules of the food in different ways like oxidation, browning and ripening. So the food items decay.

Micro-organisms: Micro-organisms such as fungi, yeast and bacteria can grow well in low temperatures. They multiply in food and spoil them.



Light: Light produces colour changes and also vitamin loss.

Temperature: Sometimes rise in temperature causes food spoilage.





Activity 2

Look at the fruits and vegetables in your house. Is there any spoiled one? Find out the reason for spoilage.

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